

1. Bridge

The Bridge stage focuses on alignment and unification. It is particularly important when an organization has multiple, fragmented digital projects running in different departments or branches. This stage brings these disparate programs together to ensure the transformation serves the organization

- Example: If a large, geographically dispersed company has a local branch in one country using one digital system while another branch uses something else, the Bridge stage would involve unifying these fragmented paths into a single organizational strategy

2. Uncover

While the sources do not provide a lengthy definition for this specific stage, it involves discovery and evaluation. Organizations must evaluate where they currently sit in their transformation journey and identify potential obstacles

- Example: A leader might perform a task to evaluate the receptiveness of senior leadership or identify where the greatest challenge might be regarding timelines and effort before proceeding

3. Iterate

The Iterate stage highlights that digital transformation is not a one-time event but a cyclical process. Organizations apply changes in increments, allowing them to move at a pace that is comfortable and manageable

- Example: Instead of a total overhaul, a company might apply digital transformation in increments, repeating the BUILD stages as they move from one department to another or as they refine a specific process

4. Leverage

To Leverage means to use specific tools, successes, or influence to sustain the transformation. A key part of this is gaining the influence and support of top leadership, as transformation is not sustainable without it

- Example: An IT director could create a prototype to demonstrate the tangible benefits of a digital shift to the CEO. By using this prototype as leverage, they win the support of top management to fund and support the project long-term

5. Disseminate

The Disseminate stage involves scaling and spreading the transformation throughout the entire entity. The goal is to move beyond localised successes to achieve advancement and success for the organisation as a whole

- Example: Once a digital process is proven successful in one department, the organization would apply it to the entire organization, including all geographically dispersed branches, rather than leaving it as a local-only improvement